Samsung Galaxy Watch Ultra 2

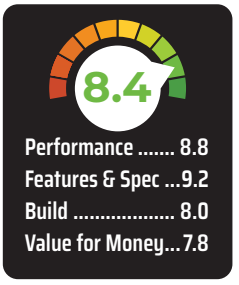
The Ultra I want to keep wearing

I'll be honest: I am probably not the ideal Galaxy Watch Ultra 2 user. I don't run marathons; I don't spend my weekends hiking up mountains; I haven't suddenly developed a passion for scuba diving either, and I definitely don't work out religiously. If you're wondering where this conversation is headed — well, I am someone who spends most of his days with a phone, a laptop, some meetings, and a desperate attempt to close my rings. Because, hey, who doesn't want to close the rings if they are wearing a smartwatch? Yet, after spending a decent amount of time with Samsung's most capable smartwatch, I think that might be a useful perspective.

₹64,999



While the Galaxy Watch Ultra 2 has been built for people who are extra serious about health and fitness, for me — I just want to know one simple thing: is this smartwatch good enough to make someone like me want to wear it again? The answer is mostly yes. Here's my full review of the Samsung Galaxy Watch Ultra 2.



FAMILIAR, BUT BETTER

If you have seen the original Galaxy Watch Ultra, you already know what to expect. Samsung hasn't reinvented the design. The cushion-shaped case is still here, the titanium construction is still here, and it remains a big, chunky watch. But look closer, and there are a few changes that make a difference.

The Galaxy Watch Ultra 2 is now 10.7mm thick, which Samsung says makes it around 12 per cent slimmer than the previous model. More importantly, the company has somehow managed to make it thinner while fitting in a much larger 800mAh battery, which, on paper, sounds impressive. On the wrist, it is even better.

One of my biggest issues with the original Watch Ultra wasn't that it was uncomfortable. It was that I was always aware that I was wearing it. It had a certain presence on the wrist, and while that is part of the appeal of an Ultra watch, it also made it feel a little too top-heavy, particularly when wearing it to bed. The Ultra 2 fixes a lot of that.

The Galaxy Watch Ultra 2 is still a large watch. Let's not pretend otherwise. If you have small wrists or prefer something discreet, this is probably not going to change your mind. But it sits better, feels less cumbersome, and has become much easier to wear for long periods. And I have to mention the strap as well.

This might genuinely be the most comfortable silicone watch strap I have used. It sounds like a minor thing to praise in a smartwatch, but it is something you are supposed to wear almost constantly. If the strap annoys you, the entire experience falls apart. Samsung has absolutely nailed it here.

The titanium body of the Galaxy Watch Ultra 2 feels appropriately premium, and I quite like the numbers printed around the outer bezel. They give the watch a slightly traditional character, which works surprisingly well with the otherwise futuristic design.

I still wish Samsung had included a physical rotating bezel. The Galaxy Watch 8 Classic has already shown why that interaction method remains brilliant. Scrolling through Wear OS using a physical bezel just feels more natural than dragging your finger around a screen. The Ultra 2's digital bezel works, but it isn't quite the same.

AMAZING DISPLAY

The Galaxy Watch Ultra 2 has a 1.52-inch Super AMOLED display with a peak brightness of up to 5,000 nits.

I remember the original Galaxy Watch Ultra having an already excellent display capable of reaching 3,000 nits. I never found myself wishing it were brighter. But the Watch Ultra 2 takes things even further, and the result is a screen that is incredibly easy to view in almost every situation.

The screen is also larger in usable area thanks to slimmer bezels. This isn't a dramatic difference when you look at the numbers, but it contributes to making the watch feel more refined.

It is sharp, colourful and very smooth. The 120Hz refresh rate makes a ton of difference. Because a smartwatch screen is tiny, responsiveness matters more than you might think. If animations stutter or apps take too long to open, you immediately notice it because every interaction is happening on such a small canvas. Thankfully, that isn't an issue here. It's a job well done..